

PART 3: SPELLS

A spell is a formula for collecting and using magical energies. A magic-user or cleric controls these energies with a memorized set of words and hand motions: the spell. Each spell has its own special set of words and gestures. Only magic-users, elves and clerics can learn these formulas, and thus only they may cast spells.

Spells must be memorized *before* an adventure begins. The character will remember the spell for any length of time until it is used. When a magic-user, elf, or cleric memorizes a spell, the words and gestures are printed on his or her mind, much in the same way that writing is put on a blackboard. When the spell is cast, the writing is "erased", and he or she may not cast that particular spell again. A spell caster may, however, memorize the same spell twice if he or she is of a high enough experience level to do so. If so, only one is "erased" when the spell is cast; the other remains and may be used later. As characters increase in level the number and type of spells they may memorize increases (their space on the blackboard increases).

Most adventures should not take more than a few hours of game time. If, however, an adventure lasts longer than a day, a character may re-memorize "erased" spells (spells already cast) once a day. First the character must be well-rested, usually an uninterrupted full night's sleep. Then by spending an hour of "character time" undisturbed, a spell caster of levels 1-3 may memorize all of his or her "erased" spells.

A character who cannot talk or use hand motions for any reason (such as being bound or gagged) cannot use a spell. Similarly, because the words and gestures must be repeated exactly, spells cannot be cast while performing any other action (such as walking or fighting).

The victim of a spell used for attack may often avoid or lessen its effects by making a **saving throw**. A saving throw represents the victim's ability to avoid or resist the worst effects of a spell by skill, luck, or reflexes. See SAVING THROWS (page B26) for more information. The victim of a spell may only "save" (make a saving throw) if the spell description permits a saving throw to be made. If a character "saves", that character either takes 1/2 the given damage, or the spell has no effect, as listed in the spell description.

Each spell has a given range and duration. Range refers to how far, in feet (10' = ten feet) the spell may be cast. A spell may be cast to any distance up to its range. ("Range: 0" means that the spell is used by touching another creature or may be used on the caster.) Duration refers to how long the effects of the spell will last. Duration is given either in rounds (of 10 seconds each) or turns (of 10 minutes each).

The following section lists the spells in D&D rules alphabetically by their character class type and spell level. Several of the spells are followed with an asterisk (*); these spells may be reversed in the D&D EXPERT rules. After the section on players' spells several higher level spells are given for the DM to use with high level NPCs.

CLERICAL SPELLS

A first level cleric cannot cast any spells. When a cleric reaches second level, however, he or she may cast one spell per adventure (or per day, if the adventure is longer than one day). A third level cleric may cast two spells per adventure (or per day). Since clerical spells are divinely given, they do not have to be studied; the cleric need only rest and then pray for them. As a result, the cleric has the choice of any spells of the same level for each adventure. Once a spell is selected, however, it cannot be changed during the course of that adventure (or day).

First Level Clerical Spells

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|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Cure Light Wounds* | 5. Protection from Evil |
| 2. Detect Evil | 6. Purify Food and Water |
| 3. Detect Magic | 7. Remove Fear* |
| 4. Light* | 8. Resist Cold |

FIRST LEVEL CLERICAL SPELLS

Cure Light Wounds*

Range: 0

Duration: permanent

This spell will heal 2-7 points (1d6 + 1) of damage done to any living creature (character or monster) when the cleric touches the individual. This spell may also be used to cure paralysis, but will not then cure any points of damage. The spell may be cast on the cleric's own body. The spell's effect will not, in any case, increase a creature's hit point total to more than the normal amount. **EXAMPLE:** Tars the fighter normally has 6 hp. In a battle with goblins, he takes 5 points of damage. Gantry the cleric casts a **cure light wounds** spell on him during the battle, and rolls a 6 on the die, which cures up to 7 points of damage. Tars is restored to his original total of 6 hp, but the 2 extra points are wasted.

Detect Evil

Range: 120'

Duration: 6 turns

This spell can be used to detect evil intentions, or evilly enchanted objects within 120' causing the creatures or objects to glow. Actual thoughts are not detected; only the "feeling of evil". The exact definition of "evil" is left to each referee, and players should discuss this point so that all are in agreement; "Chaotic" is not always "evil". Poison and physical traps are neither good nor evil.

Detect Magic

Range: 60'

Duration: 2 turns

This spell determines if there has been an enchantment laid upon a person, place, or thing, causing any magic item within 60' to glow. Several items may be tested until the spell's duration has ended. It is useful, for example, to discover if some item is magical, if a door has been magically "held" or "wizard locked" (see **Magic-user and Elf Spells**), and so forth.

Light*

Range: 120'

Duration: 12 turns

This spell casts light in a circle, 30' in diameter. It is bright enough to read by, but not equal to full daylight. It may be cast on an object. The **light** may be cast at a creature's eyes. The creature may make a saving throw, but if it fails, the victim will be blinded for 12 turns. In the D&D BASIC rules, a blinded creature may not attack.

Protection from Evil

Range: 0 (caster only)

Duration: 12 turns

This spell circles the cleric with a magic barrier. This barrier will move with the caster. The spell serves as some protection from "evil" attacks (attacks by monsters of some alignment other than the cleric's alignment) by adding 1 to the cleric's saving throws, and subtracting 1 from the "to hit" die roll of these opponents. The spell will also keep out hand-to-hand attacks from enchanted (summoned or created) monsters (such as living statues), but not missile fire attacks from these creatures (see **COMBAT**). The cleric may break this protection by attacking the monster in hand-to-hand combat, but still gains the bonus "to hit" and saves.

Purify Food and Water

Range: 10'

Duration: indefinite

This spell will make spoiled or poisoned food and water usable. The spell will purify one ration of food (iron or standard), 6 skins of water, or enough normal food to feed a dozen people.